

Harnessing the power of the arts to end the **loneliness epidemic** in creative communities.

Sprout Society builds the spaces and networks where creatives
belong.



The loneliness epidemic can be **fatal** — and creatives are especially exposed.

Roughly **half of US adults** report experiencing loneliness, which the Surgeon General warns is as damaging to health as **smoking 15 cigarettes a day**.

For independent creatives, the risk runs higher—because isolation is built into the work itself: it's solitary, financially precarious, and lacking the infrastructure and stability most careers provide.

1/2

of US adults
report
experiencing
loneliness



The result is a difficult irony: the people who create connection for everyone else are too often **left without it themselves.**

Artists are our connectors and storytellers. We rely on them to connect, heal, and inspire everyone else. Creatives need more support and community in order to thrive.

We offer infrastructure and opportunity so **no one builds a creative life alone.**

From our flagship space in Bushwick to events on the road and online, we offer creatives:



Community

Among artists who understand the work — both in person and online.



Dedicated physical space

A reliable home base to work, collaborate, and share their craft.



Economic opportunity

Through networking and resources to pursue a vibrant creative life.



Coaching & education

To navigate an unmarked path.



WHO IS RUSSELL "SPROUTS"?

Sprout Society was founded in memory of **Russell J. Efras**.

Russell was a Brooklyn musician, artist, and filmmaker with a gift for making everyone around him feel they belonged. He also struggled with the effects of loneliness. In 2018, at 25, he died of fentanyl poisoning—in the middle of building the very thing Sprout is today: a space to connect and showcase creatives.

His family founded the Russell J. Efras Foundation to bring his vision to life. That foundation grew into **Sprout Society**.

Sprout hosts different ways to connect, **every** **day.**



Art, music & film
from the
community,
performed and
shown in the space



Special-interest and hobby
groups



Daytime coworking for
independent creatives



Creative workshops and
classes



Peer-led support groups

By the numbers, so far.

5,000+

people served across our
programs

50+

distinct programs
developed

\$1.7M

raised to sustain the work

Free

or low-cost—with
scholarships to ensure
access

// Space reserved for testimonials & survey results

We invest in creatives through **grantmaking**.

Through the **Sprout Fund**, we've directed over **\$120,000** to **32 artists' projects** —seed support for the work that connects communities.



\$120K

**to 32 artists'
projects**

The next chapter is connection **at scale**—beyond our four walls.

WHAT WE'RE BUILDING NOW

A live calendar

Connecting creative communities—the Infatuation for creative life.

XXX

XXX

XXX

XXX

We will be assessing success based on...

Community:

How are you connecting

Online community numbers

How do they feel being connected

Collaborations

Mentorship

Calendar: Impressions > engagement > sign ups

Economic opportunity:

-how much \$ are you infusing into the creative arts

-how many artists are you showcasing

-whats the impact of showcasing with you

-their income numbers?

Dedicated physical space:

Programming

Attendees

Sentiment

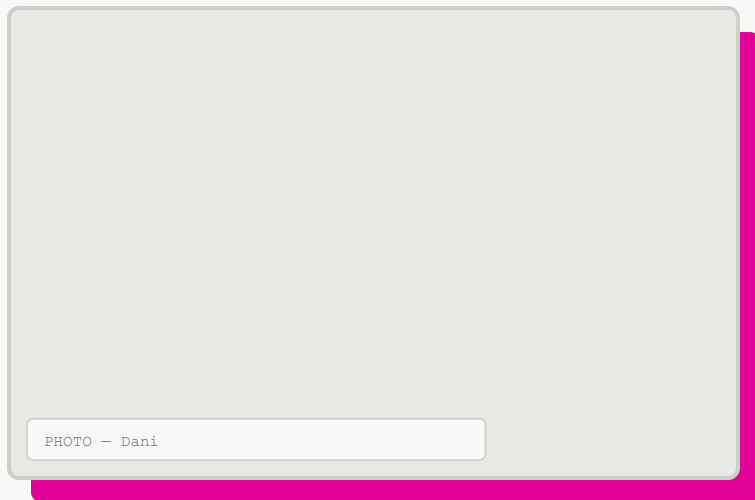
Coaching & education:

What opportunities are opening up

Partnerships and speakers

A future where the **creative life** is connected, supported, and full of opportunity.

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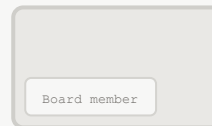
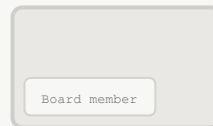
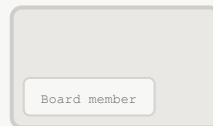
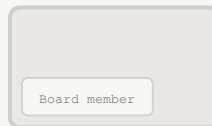


LEADERSHIP

XXX

XXXX

BOARD OF DIRECTORS



Get Involved

Whether you give time, money, or your craft—here's how to be part of it.



Give time

Volunteer, mentor, or host a group in the space.



Give money

Fund programs and grants that keep access free and open.



Give your craft

Show work, lead a workshop, or share your skills.

sproutsociety.org · hello@sproutsociety.org